

Die spammers!

Don't you hate seeing your inbox full of spam every morning? Junk mails that are mostly scams, and there's not a thing you can do about it. Not any more, if the American Federal Trade Commission (FTC) has its way.

The FTC has sued four Web-based scams like chain letter schemes to false cancer cures. They have also initiated legal action against 63 cases of Internet fraud in the last four months. Many of them have had to shut down operations. Looks like ordinary people are having their voice heard at last.

One of the saddest

victims of these scams is Peter Fulton who was fooled by a Web site selling cancer cures. These cures costing around \$2,400 to \$5,200 were claimed to cure cancer without surgery, chemotherapy or other such cancer treatments. Fulton's wife,

who was suffering from inoperable pancreatic cancer, passed away since the cures had no effect at all.

The site has been brought down, but the damage has been done. Here's hoping that FTC's actions will bring down spam on a whole.



Learning from mothers

We are all proud of our moms, no matter how much they nag us. But Dan Baber from Michigan, USA apparently decided to go one step further. He started with trying to persuade people to

buy one day of his mom's attention. The offer was that his mom would e-mail the 'buyer' for one whole day.

He put her thoughts for sale as Item # 1527369622 on eBay titled "Best Mother in the World—Her Thoughts." His mom would e-mail or send a written response

about her thoughts on how she brought up Dan and his sister. It has done surprisingly well since the bidding has reached \$610, even though the first bid was for \$1!

Well, it would seem that more people care about mother's advice than they actually admit.



KDE 3.0 is out

A new version of KDE, one of the better looking GUIs available for Linux, has been released. It



has better multimedia, e-mail and printing capabilities, support for 50 languages, and more.

Konqueror, the file manager-cum-Web browser, now has support for JavaScript, Java, XML 1.0, CSS, HTML 4, and SSL along with Flash and RealAudio support.

heroes

Chameleon

A programmable microchip named after the camouflaging reptile is the next shift in handheld technology. With it, a handheld can change back and forth between a mobile phone, PDA, and a mobile entertainment device. Truly chameleonic!

Simulators

Australian education authorities are convinced that certain computer games, SimCity, for example, can be used as a learning tool for building strategic planning and team-building skills in young students. Schools in Australia's capital have already launched pilot projects at the primary level.

zeroes

PS2

A critical 8MB memory stick upgrade used to save games, particularly the lengthy RPG types, is in short supply.irate customers caught unaware claim it's like getting the machine without a power cord.

Net Advertising

Web site owners are turning to downloadable software rather than pop-up advertising. Not only will this suck already skim bandwidth, but Net users are also complaining that some of these ads redirect them to adult content sites.

snapshot

64%

of online consumers distrust Web sites

Source: www.nua.com